

MAHADEU SEN

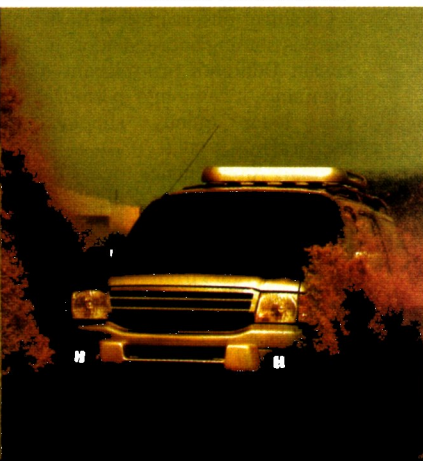
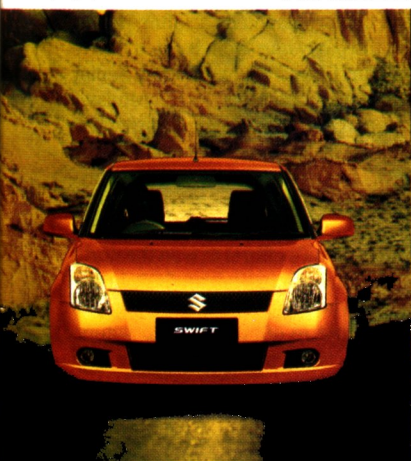
# POOR CITY: Violence breaks out in Mumbai (far left); migrants from the north hold protests

Progressive Alliance (UNPA), comprising the Third Front parties, at Shivaji Park on January 3 provided Raj the perfect platform to launch his attack. Already in a war of words with SP leader Abu Asim Azmi, his supporters went on an anti-uttar bharatiya (north Indian) rampage and began thrashing auto rickshaw and taxi drivers, mostly hailing from the two cow belt states, pelting stones, smashing vehicles, shutting down shops and ransacking cinema halls screening Bhojpuri films in Nasik and Thane. The bashing continued as hapless travellers—all migrants—were pulled out of trains and beaten up, a stark reminder of the dark days when Shiv Sainiks targeted and thrashed candidates from Bihar who arrived in the city to take the Railways exams.

If Raj was scrambling to be the talking point, so was Azmi and SP. Shaken by Bahujan Samaj Party's (BSP) growing influence in the state, the party took the opportunity to sell itself as the messiah of the north Indians. Azmi said, "Raj is frustrated since he is facing political

isolation and hasn't managed to consolidate a vote bank." All said and done, if hogging prime time news space was Raj's sole agenda then he did succeed but political leaders cutting across party lines have slammed him for inciting violence. Jaya Bachchan, reacting to the attacks on her husband, refused to even acknowledge Raj as a Thackeray. "I know Bal Thackeray—he is like a father to me—and Uddhav Thackeray. I don't know any other Thackeray." The film fraternity rallied around the Bachchans with directors, producers and actors venting their ire on MNS. Shiv Sena spokesperson Sanjay Raut said, "Raj is facing an identity crisis. He started off with a secular ideology but that didn't work, so he is now whipping up Maratha sentiments."

Unwilling to risk the local voter's ire, the state's politicians are keeping mum on Raj's tirade against migrants. Without naming him, BJP state president Nitin Gadkari condemned the violence explaining that involved parties were merely playing vote bank politics. "The attacks on migrants are very unfortunate. Taking the law into one's hands to beat up innocent people



## Any Vehicle.

## Any Terrain.

## 100% Performance. Every time.

You love to take your vehicle everywhere - be it cruising on the highways or manoeuvring on the city roads, or exploring a muddy trail or driving over a rocky outback. Each terrain challenges the engine differently. That's why you need **SERVO** Engine Oils, which are specially developed to maximize engine performance even under the most demanding conditions. So that, no matter which vehicle you drive or what terrain you choose, your vehicle will be more than ready to give you a smooth ride. Every time.

• Engine Oils • Brake Fluids • Gear Oils • Coolants • Greases



Rediffusion-DYR/Bom/IOCL/3358 r